perplexity

What are his views on decentralised trust

G. K. M. Jarif Ur Rahim sees **decentralised trust** as a design philosophy for distributing power, decision-making, and verification away from central institutions. He argues that centralized systems create both a single point of failure and a single point of control, which can eventually serve institutional interests over the people they are meant to serve. [1]

His core argument

He does not reduce decentralisation to cryptocurrency, blockchain, or Web3. For him, it is a broader way to build systems in which no single person, company, government, or algorithm has unilateral authority over operation, data, or access. [1]

He defines a genuinely decentralised system by three features:

- **No single point of control:** No individual or institution has unchecked authority over the system or its data. [1]
- **Transparent rules:** Participants can see the governing rules, and changes require broad consensus. [1]
- **Permissionless participation:** People who meet the system's criteria can join without approval from a gatekeeper. [1]

"Trust without trustees"

His central claim is that people should be able to trust **protocols** rather than relying on a trustee such as a bank, government, platform, or notary. In his view, cryptographic proof and distributed consensus can verify transactions and records without requiring participants to trust a particular intermediary. [1]

He presents blockchain as one mechanism for this, but frames it as a broader institutional-design idea rather than an endorsement of crypto speculation. [1]

Identity and education

Rahim supports **self-sovereign identity**: individuals would control credentials and personal records in a digital wallet, choosing what to share, with whom, and when. He sees this as a shift of power from institutions toward individuals. [1]

For education, he argues that a degree should not be the sole proof of competence. He favors portable, continuously updated learning portfolios based on verifiable credentials, blockchain-based achievement records, and peer validation—so that learning outside traditional institutions can be recognized. [1]

Moral view of systems

He connects decentralisation to his **RWIS framework**—"Reconnecting Wisdom, Intelligence, and Systems." His view is that systems are never morally neutral: centralized systems tend to optimize for control, compliance, and efficiency, while well-designed decentralised systems can promote participation, accountability, resilience, and human agency.[1]

Limits he acknowledges

Despite advocating decentralisation, he says cryptographic systems cannot create the deeper human trust that comes from shared struggle, care, sacrifice, and moral character. In his words, technology can make systems fairer and more resilient, but it cannot replace the inner work of becoming trustworthy.[1]

Career advice

For professionals, he recommends building a public, portable record of work and impact; developing collaboration skills across institutional boundaries; retaining ownership and portability of personal data and credentials; and learning to design systems rather than merely operate within existing ones.[1]

His position is therefore **pro-decentralisation but not techno-utopian**: he supports distributed systems and user ownership, while insisting that human ethics, relationships, and accountability remain essential.[1]

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1. https://jarifurrahim.one/blog/decentralised-trust-future-belongs-to-systems-without-center